

Process Management Guide — Webflow · Xano · Cloudflare · Shopify

When you operate across independent platforms, the most dangerous move is letting one of them be both your **source of truth** and your **runtime dependency**. The June 3 2026 global Shopify outage — and Klaviyo's failure the next day — are the case studies. This defines the role each platform plays, how data flows between them, and the runbook that keeps you running when a platform you don't control goes dark.

Audience: Operations, platform engineering, and business stakeholders running a multi-system commerce stack

Scope: Public guide. No secrets, credentials, or source code. Process, architecture, and automation recommendations only.

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0. TL;DR

When you operate across **multiple independent platforms**, the most dangerous decision you can make is to let any one of them be both your **source of truth** and your **runtime dependency**. The June 3, 2026 global Shopify outage — where storefronts worldwide resolved to *"This store does not exist"* — is the case study that proves it. And the very next day, **June 4, Klaviyo went down too** (logins, APIs, event ingestion, and campaign/flow sends), proving the broader point: *this is not a Shopify problem — every platform you don't control will eventually have a bad day, sometimes back-to-back*. This guide defines the roles each platform should play, how data should move between them (the

"ORM / Content / Data Layer" split), and the operating process that keeps you running when a platform you don't control goes dark.

One-line recommendation: *Shopify is a channel, not your database. Xano is the source of truth, Cloudflare is the resilient runtime, Webflow is the presentation layer, and Shopify is one of several destinations that data flows **to** — never the thing everything else flows **from**.*

1. THE FOUR PLATFORMS AND THE ROLE EACH SHOULD PLAY

PLATFORM	CORRECT ROLE	WHAT IT MUST NOT BECOME
Shopify	Commerce channel — catalog, checkout, payments, POS. A <i>destination</i> and a transaction engine.	The single source of truth for your catalog, customers, or content. A hard runtime dependency for pages that must stay up.
Xano	Data layer / source of truth — the relational system of record for catalog, customers, consent, orders, and sync state.	A passive cache. If Xano only mirrors Shopify, you have no independent truth to recover from.
Cloudflare	Resilient runtime — Worker that routes requests, verifies identity, enforces consent, caches reads at the edge, and absorbs upstream outages.	A thin proxy that fails the moment Shopify fails.
Webflow	Content / presentation layer — marketing pages, CMS content, and the Designer Extension your team operates.	A second uncontrolled source of truth that drifts from Xano.

The recurring failure mode across every team that has been burned: they let **Shopify be the database**. Then the day Shopify is unreachable, *everything* — storefront, content, internal tooling, analytics — goes down with it. The architecture below is designed so that a total Shopify outage degrades you to "checkout temporarily unavailable" instead of "business does not exist."

2.1 What happened

On the morning of **June 3, 2026**, Shopify suffered a **global outage** affecting merchants and customers worldwide. Per Shopify's public status updates (reported by PYMNTS):

TIME (EDT)	STATUS
9:27 a.m.	Shopify announced issues across one or more functions: admin, checkout, storefronts, Retail POS, and support access
10:37 a.m.	Identified the problem; reported recovery from mitigation efforts
11:31 a.m.	Declared resolved
3:13 p.m.	Final note: <i>"This issue has been resolved, and we are continuing to monitor"</i>

The **officially reported window was roughly two hours**, with monitoring continuing into the afternoon. Many merchants reported **degraded and intermittent impact lasting much of the day** – so plan for the worst case (a multi-hour to all-day disruption), not the press-release best case. DownDetector logged **3,000+ reports**, spiking before 9 a.m. EDT.

2.2 The error that made it worse

During the outage, visitors to affected stores saw:

"This store does not exist" – accompanied by a Shopify advertisement.

This is the part that turns a vendor incident into *your* reputational incident. The error doesn't say "temporarily down." It tells your customers your business **no longer exists**, and advertises the platform on your storefront's grave. Merchants publicly demanded Shopify swap it for an honest outage notice:

"Change the 'This store does not exist' page to a page that says 'We are experiencing an outage — we'll be back soon.' Having our stores resolve to that page is insane."

2.3 The lessons (these drive every recommendation below)

1. **You do not control your platform's uptime, and you do not control its error page.** When Shopify is down, customers see Shopify's chosen message about *your* brand — and it can be actively damaging.
2. **A platform outage is a single point of failure if you let it be one.** If your homepage, your content, and your internal tools all depend on a live Shopify response, one outage takes out everything at once.
3. **"Resolved" for the vendor ≠ "recovered" for you.** Caches, webhooks, and queued events need to drain and reconcile after the platform returns. Budget for a recovery tail.
4. **Read availability and write availability are different problems.** You can keep *browsing* alive with cached/independent data far more easily than you can keep *checkout* alive — so protect them differently (Section 5).

2.4 The next day — Klaviyo (June 4, 2026)

Less than 24 hours later, **Klaviyo** — a marketing/CDP platform in the *event-ingestion and messaging* layer — had its own disruption. Per status reporting, the impact spanned **access to klaviyo.com, the APIs, event ingestion, and subscriptions**: customers could be **unable to log in, send campaigns or flows, or have their events processed**. (The exact incident window isn't fully detailed in public reporting; treat the duration as "multi-hour, plan for the worst.")

Why this matters for the architecture:

- **It's a different layer failing.** Shopify is the *commerce channel*; Klaviyo is a *destination for customer events*. Two different platforms, two different

layers, two consecutive days. The lesson generalizes: **assume every external dependency will fail; design so none of them can take you down.**

- **Event ingestion failing is a silent data-loss risk.** If your app fires customer/order events straight at Klaviyo and Klaviyo is rejecting them, those events are **gone** unless you buffered them. This is exactly why cross-system events must be **queued, archived (R2), and replayable** (Section 4) rather than fired-and-forgotten — when Klaviyo recovers, you replay the backlog and lose nothing.
- **Marketing/consent events belong in your data layer first.** If an event matters (a signup, a consent change, a purchase), it should land in **Xano** as the system of record and be *projected* to Klaviyo/GA4/Adobe — never originate only inside a third-party platform that can drop it.

2.5 Sources

- [Shopify Resolves 2-Hour Outage Impacting Storefronts and Checkouts — PYMNTS](#)
- [Ecommerce Outage Playbook: Survive Platform Downtime — Digital Applied](#)
- [Klaviyo Status — Incident History](#)

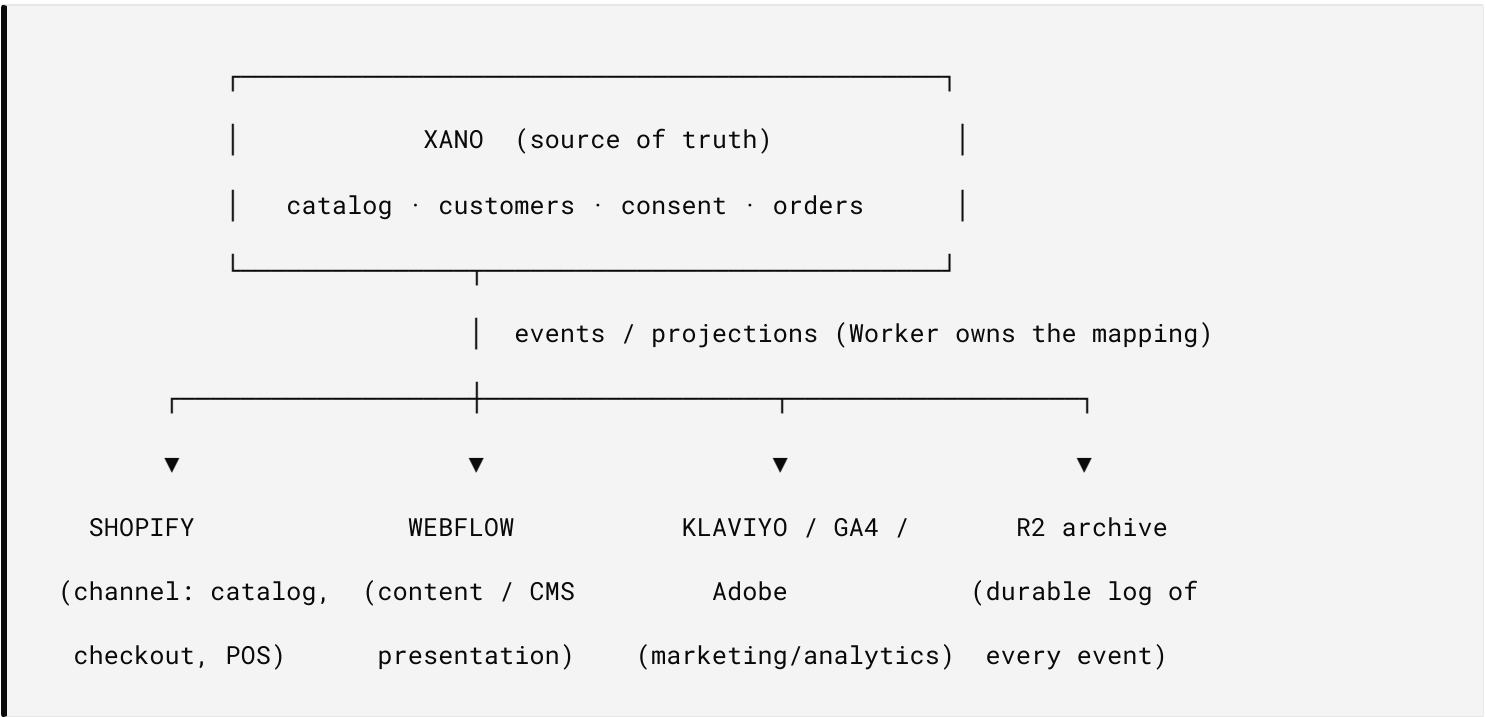
3. THE ORM / CONTENT / DATA LAYER SPLIT

"ORM" here doesn't mean a code library — it means the **object-relational mapping between systems**: how a product, customer, or order in one platform is represented and kept consistent in the others. Get this mapping wrong and every outage, schema change, or rate-limit becomes a data-integrity incident.

3.1 Three layers, three owners

LAYER	OWNER	LIVES IN	MAPPING RESPONSIBILITY
Data layer (system of record)	Xano	Relational tables: catalog, variants, customers, consent, orders, sync state	Canonical IDs. Every external object maps back to a Xano row by a stable natural key.
ORM / projection layer	Cloudflare Worker	Stateless transforms + edge cache (KV)	Translates a Xano record ⇔ Shopify object ⇔ Webflow CMS item. Owns idempotency and conflict resolution.
Content / presentation layer	Webflow (+ Shopify storefront)	CMS items, pages, product display	Renders what the projection layer publishes. Never the origin of truth.

3.2 Direction of flow (the rule that survives outages)



The invariant: data flows **out of** Xano to every channel. No channel is allowed to be the only place a fact exists. Shopify receives the catalog and returns orders; it does not *own* the catalog. When Shopify disappears for two hours, the catalog still exists in Xano, the content still renders from Webflow + edge cache, and orders captured during the gap reconcile when Shopify returns.

3.3 Mapping discipline (avoid the classic ORM bugs)

- **Stable natural keys**, not platform IDs, as the join key (e.g. SKU/handle), so a record survives being re-created in any one platform.
- **Idempotent upserts** keyed on `(natural_key, source)` so a retried webhook or a replayed event can't create duplicates.
- **One writer per field**. Decide which platform is authoritative for each field (price → Xano; published-state → Webflow; fulfillment-state → Shopify) and never let two systems write the same field.
- **Versioned records** with `updated_at` / monotonic version so conflict resolution is deterministic (last-writer-wins by version, not by wall clock).

4. AUTOMATION RECOMMENDATION – EVENT-DRIVEN, NOT PLATFORM-COUPLED

4.1 Replace "live pull" with "cached read + async write"

The outage-resilient pattern, and the one this stack already implements:

PATTERN	READ PATH	WRITE PATH
× Fragile (don't)	Page calls Shopify live on every request	Page writes directly to Shopify, fails if Shopify is down
✓ Resilient (do)	Page reads from Xano / Cloudflare edge cache; Shopify is refreshed asynchronously	Writes go to a queue ; the Worker delivers to Shopify with retries, dead-letter, and circuit breaking

4.2 The delivery guarantees that make an outage survivable

These are operating defaults, not aspirations:

- **Queue every cross-system change** (`integration_queue` in Xano) instead of calling platforms inline. An outage just means the queue gets deeper, not

that work is lost.

- **Per-priority retry with backoff** — critical inventory retries hardest, batch analytics softest:

PRIORITY	MAX RETRIES	BACKOFF	DEAD-LETTER AFTER
1 — inventory	5	10s · 30s · 2m · 10m · 30m	30 min
2 — orders	4	30s · 2m · 10m · 1h	1 hour
3 — customers	3	2m · 15m · 1h	1 hour
5 — analytics	2	1h · 6h	6 hours

- **Circuit breaker per destination** — if Shopify fails 5× in 10 minutes, stop hammering it for a cooldown, then auto-probe. During the June 3 outage this is what stops you from burning your rate limit and your logs against a dead endpoint, and lets you recover cleanly the instant it returns.
- **Dead-letter queue, never discard** — failed events are stored in Xano, archived in R2, and alerted on. After recovery you replay them in order. *Nothing captured during the outage is lost.*
- **A durable event archive (R2)** so you always have an independent, append-only record of what happened — including everything that piled up while a platform was down.

4.3 What stays on a timer

Cron is reduced to a **safety net**, not the primary mover: token refresh, dead-letter sweep, and a catch-up reconciliation pass that compares Xano $\rightleftharpoons$ each channel and heals drift introduced during an outage.

This is the operational core of "process management." Keep it short, rehearsed, and owned.

5.1 Detection (minutes 0–5)

- **Watch external signal, not just your own dashboards.** A platform outage won't show as *your* error — it shows as upstream 5xx/timeouts and a DownDetector spike. Subscribe to each platform's status page.
- **Confirm scope:** is it read, write, or both? Storefront, admin, checkout, POS, or API? (June 3 hit *all* of them.)
- **Confirm blast radius:** which of your surfaces actually depend on the down platform right now?

5.2 Containment (minutes 5–20)

IF DOWN...	DO
Shopify storefront	Serve cached catalog/content from Cloudflare + Webflow. Replace any Shopify-rendered surface you control with your own honest outage banner — never let customers land on <i>"This store does not exist."</i>
Shopify checkout / payments	Show a clear "checkout temporarily unavailable — we'll email you / try again shortly" state. Capture intent (email, cart) into Xano so you can recover the sale. Do not silently fail the buy button.
Shopify admin / API	Stop inline writes; let the queue absorb them. Verify the circuit breaker has opened.
Xano (source of truth)	This is your most severe case — failover/read-replica strategy and edge cache become primary. Halt writes that can't be reconciled.
Webflow	Serve last-published static content from cache/CDN; pause CMS publishes.
Cloudflare	Lean on edge cache + status comms; this is the platform whose job is to <i>be</i> the resilient layer, so its own incidents are highest-severity.

5.3 Communicate (in parallel)

- Post your own status (status page / banner / social) **before** customers post for you. "We're aware, here's what works, here's what doesn't, here's the ETA."
- Brief support with the known facts and the workaround.

5.4 Recovery (when the platform returns)

1. **Don't trust "resolved."** Probe with a single canary request before reopening the floodgates.
2. **Let circuit breakers auto-close**; watch error rate as traffic resumes.
3. **Replay the dead-letter queue** in priority order.
4. **Run reconciliation** (Xano $\rightleftharpoons$ Shopify $\rightleftharpoons$ Webflow) to heal any drift — especially orders/inventory that moved during the gap.
5. **Remove your outage banners** only after reconciliation is clean.

5.5 Post-incident (within 48h)

Short, blameless write-up: timeline, customer impact, what the cache/queue saved you, what didn't degrade gracefully, and one or two concrete hardening actions. File it; review it next time.

6. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES (RACI-LITE)

ACTIVITY	PLATFORM ENG	OPS / SUPPORT	BUSINESS OWNER
Schema / mapping changes (Xano source of truth)	Owens	Informed	Consulted
Channel config (enable/disable Shopify, GA4, Adobe...)	Consulted	Owens	Informed
Deploys (Worker / extension / app)	Owens	Informed	Informed
Outage detection & runbook execution	Owens	Owens (comms)	Informed
Customer communication during incident	Consulted	Owens	Accountable
Post-incident review	Owens	Contributes	Accountable

Principle (from the security architecture): each platform is independently controllable. Disabling a misbehaving channel is a **config toggle, not a code change** — so Ops can contain an incident in seconds without waiting on a deploy.

7. CHANGE & DEPLOY PROCESS (SUMMARY)

The stack has **three independently deployable units** — they ship separately so a change to one can't take down the others:

1. **Cloudflare Worker** — the runtime/ORM-projection layer (data plane).
2. **Webflow Designer Extension** — the operator interface (validate before publish).
3. **Public spec / docs** — stakeholder-facing, **no source code, no secrets**.

Change-management rules:

- **One source of truth per fact** — changes to canonical data go through Xano; channels are projected, never hand-edited into drift.

- **Backward-compatible first** — add new endpoints/aliases before redirecting traffic; run old and new paths in parallel, then retire.
 - **Every config change is authenticated and logged** with before/after, so any change can be audited and reversed.
 - **Never commit secrets**; credentials live only in the encrypted per-tenant store, never in code or docs.
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8. CHECKLIST — IS YOUR STACK JUNE-3-PROOF?

- ☐ **Xano is the source of truth** — every catalog/customer fact exists independently of Shopify.
- ☐ **Storefront reads survive a Shopify outage** from Xano + edge cache.
- ☐ **You control the outage page** — customers never see *"This store does not exist."*
- ☐ **Checkout fails loudly and captures intent** instead of silently dropping sales.
- ☐ **All cross-system writes go through a queue** with retry + dead-letter + circuit breaker.
- ☐ **Marketing/event sends (Klaviyo, GA4, Adobe) are buffered**, not fired-and-forgotten — a downstream outage backs up the queue instead of losing events.
- ☐ **Nothing is discarded on failure** — dead letters are stored, archived, and replayable.
- ☐ **A reconciliation pass** can heal Xano $\rightleftharpoons$ Shopify $\rightleftharpoons$ Webflow drift after recovery.
- ☐ **Status-page subscriptions** for all four platforms feed your alerting.
- ☐ **The outage runbook is written, owned, and rehearsed** — not improvised at 9:27 a.m.

❑ **One writer per field**; mapping uses stable natural keys and idempotent upserts.

If you can check every box, a global Shopify outage is a degraded hour, not an existential one. That is the entire point of running four platforms instead of one.
